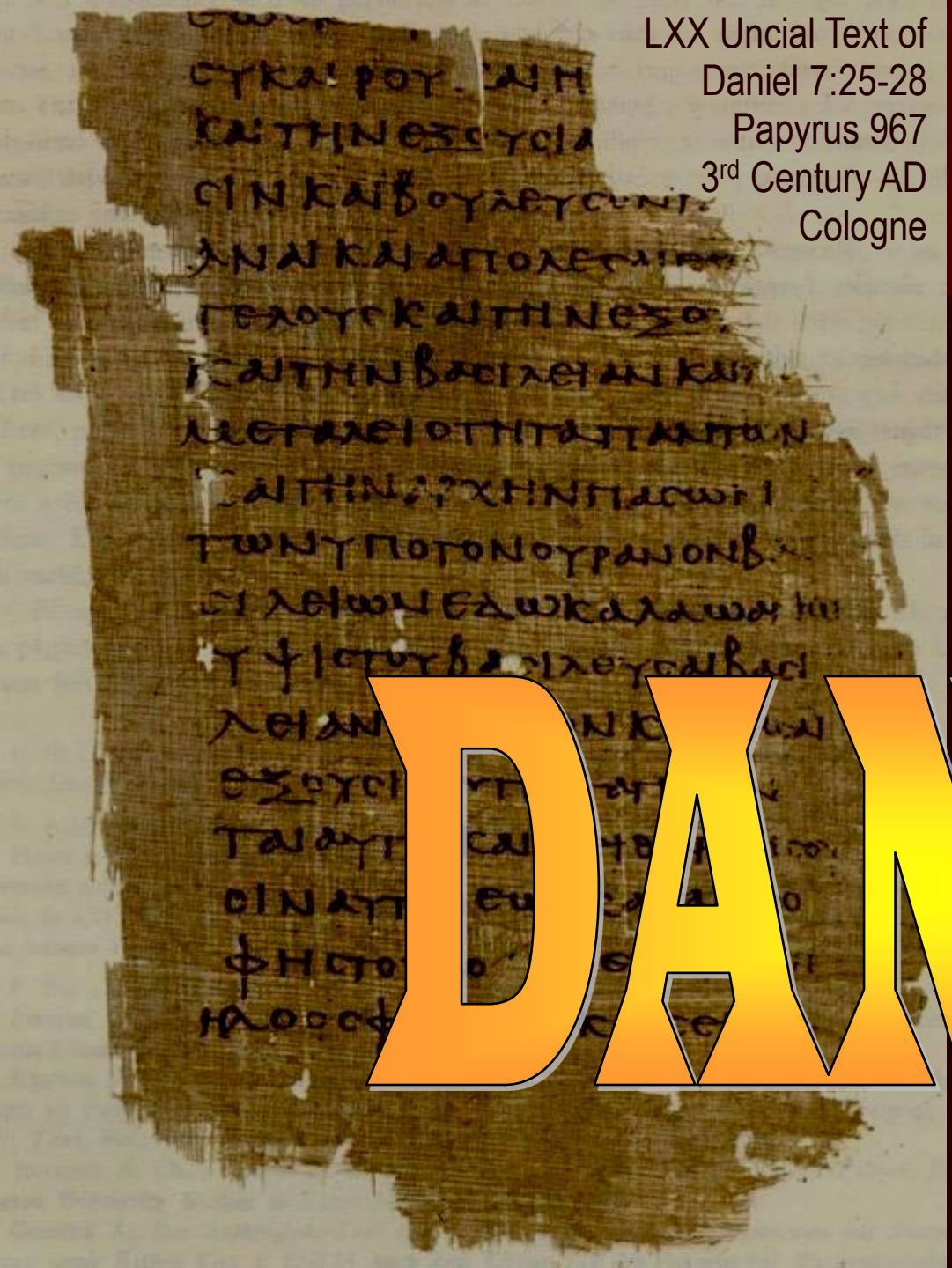

LXX Uncial Text of
Daniel 7:25-28
Papyrus 967
3rd Century AD
Cologne

Book of DANIEL

Apocalyptic Section

Daniel 7-12

Four Dated Visions

- Dream of World Empires (7:1ff.)
- Vision of the Ram and the Goat (8:1ff.)
- Prediction of the Seventy Weeks (9:1ff.)
- Vision of the Kings of the North and the South (10:1ff)

Note that the four apocalyptic visions are not sequential with the prior historical section of the book.

The Rise of Apocalyptic

Close of the OT

Beginning of the gospel

The "Silent" Years

PROPHETS

Promised exile and restoration

APOCALYPTISTS

Answered unfulfilled expectations

CHRIST

Prepared his disciples for the course of the age

Question: *Is the Book of Daniel a true apocalyptic work?*

- *In style, chapters 2, 7-12 fit well.*
- *However, the book contains more historical narrative than classical apocalyptic.*
- *Those holding a Maccabean view of the book's origin claim that it is pseudonymous; those who accept a 6th century date do not.*
- *Daniel was canonized by the Jews; apocalyptic works were not canonized.*

Ancient Near Eastern Iconography of Composite Creatures

(British Museum)

Composite creatures combine the features of power, speed, intelligence and status.

Composite creature from the palace of Sargon II, Khorsabad.

This figure was excavated in 1929 by archaeologists from the University of Chicago.

The piece stands over 16’ tall and weighs more than 40 tons.

Oriental Institute, Chicago

As in Assyrian and Babylonian art, this dragon from Susa, Persia employs the typical composite features: the forelegs and body of a lion, the hind feet of an eagle, eagle's wings, and ram's horns.

DREAM OF WORLD EMPIRES

Daniel 2	Daniel 7
Head	LION WITH EAGLE'S WINGS
Chest & Arms	BEAR WITH CARCASS IN ITS MOUTH
Belly & Thighs	FOUR-HEADED LEOPARD
Legs, Feet & Toes	TERRIBLE BEAST WITH TEN HORNS

Critical Interpretive Issues:

1. *If the vision of the four beasts parallels Nebuchadnezzar's dream, then the first beast must be Babylon (cf. 2:38).*
2. *Is a fifth kingdom represented by the 10 horns? (the text specifically says "the four great beasts are four kingdoms", cf. 7:17)*

MACCABEAN

Lion with Eagle's Wings

Babylon

Bear with Carcass

Media

Four-headed Leopard

Persia

Ten-horned Beast

Greece

- *Alexander the Great*
- *The Diadochi struggle*
- *Seleucus I Nicator*
- *Antiochus I Soter*
- *Antiochus II Theos*
- *Seleucus II Callinicus*
- *Seleucus III Soter*
- *Antiochus IV Philopator*
- *Antiochus IV Epiphanes*

(little horn)

MESSIANIC

Lion with Eagle's Wings

Babylon

Bear with Carcass

Medo-Persia

Four-headed Leopard

Greece

Ten-horned Beast

Rome

- *Julius Caesar*
- *Augustus Caesar*
- *Tiberius Caesar*
- *Gaius Caligula Caesar*
- *Claudius Caesar*
- *Nero Caesar*
- *Galba*
- *Otho*
- *Vitellius*
- *Vespasian Caesar*
- *Titus Caesar*

(little horn)

DISPENSATIONAL

Lion with Eagle's Wings

Babylon

Bear with Carcass

Medo-Persia

Four-headed Leopard

Greece

Ten-horned Beast

Rome

Ten Horns

European Union (the number of member countries has varied since its 20th century origin as the European Economic Common Market)

Eschatological Antichrist

(little horn)

Interpreting the Fourth Beast

Da. 7:7-27

MACCABEAN

Little Horn

Antiochus IV Epiphanes

Time, Times and ½ Time

168-164 BC, the temple's desecration

One Like a Son of Man

Collective image of the people of Israel

Everlasting Kingdom

Maccabean independence

MESSIANIC

Little Horn

Titus

Time, Times and ½ Time

AD 66-70, the First Jewish Revolt

One Like a Son of Man

The ascension and exaltation of Christ

Everlasting Kingdom

Kingdom of God inaugurated by Christ

DISPENSATIONAL

Little Horn

Antichrist

Time, Times and ½ Time

Last 3 ½ years of the great tribulation at the end of the age

One Like a Son of Man

The second coming of Christ

Everlasting Kingdom

Millennial reign of Christ

THE WAR WITH THE SAINTS

MACCABEAN

The war with the saints (7:21, 25) is to be linked with the rebellion that causes desolation (8:10-14, 24), the decree of desolations (9:26-27), and the abomination of desolation (9:27; 11:30-32).

This abomination was fulfilled in the Maccabean Period when Antiochus IV Epiphanes desecrated the second temple (1 Maccabees 1:54).

MESSIANIC

The war with the saints cannot be exhausted by events in the Maccabean Period, since Jesus regarded the abomination of desolation as still future (Mt. 24:15; Mk.13:14).

The war with the saints and the desolation of the temple is to be linked to the siege of Jerusalem by Titus near the end of the First Jewish Revolt in AD 70 (Lk. 21:20-24).

DISPENSATIONAL

The war with the saints cannot be exhausted by events in the Maccabean Period, since Jesus regarded the abomination of desolation as still future (Mt. 24:15; Mk. 13:14).

The persecution of the saints is to be linked with the attacks of the dragon (Rv. 12:17) and the beast (Rv. 13:7), events to occur during the Great Tribulation at the end of the age.

Three Great Temple Desecrations

168 BC

Antiochus IV Epiphanes erects an altar to Zeus in the second temple (Da. 11:31)

AD 70

Titus destroys the second temple (Mt. 24:2)

END OF THE AGE (?)

St. Paul offers an enigmatic reference to the man of lawlessness sitting in God's temple (2 Th. 2:4)